

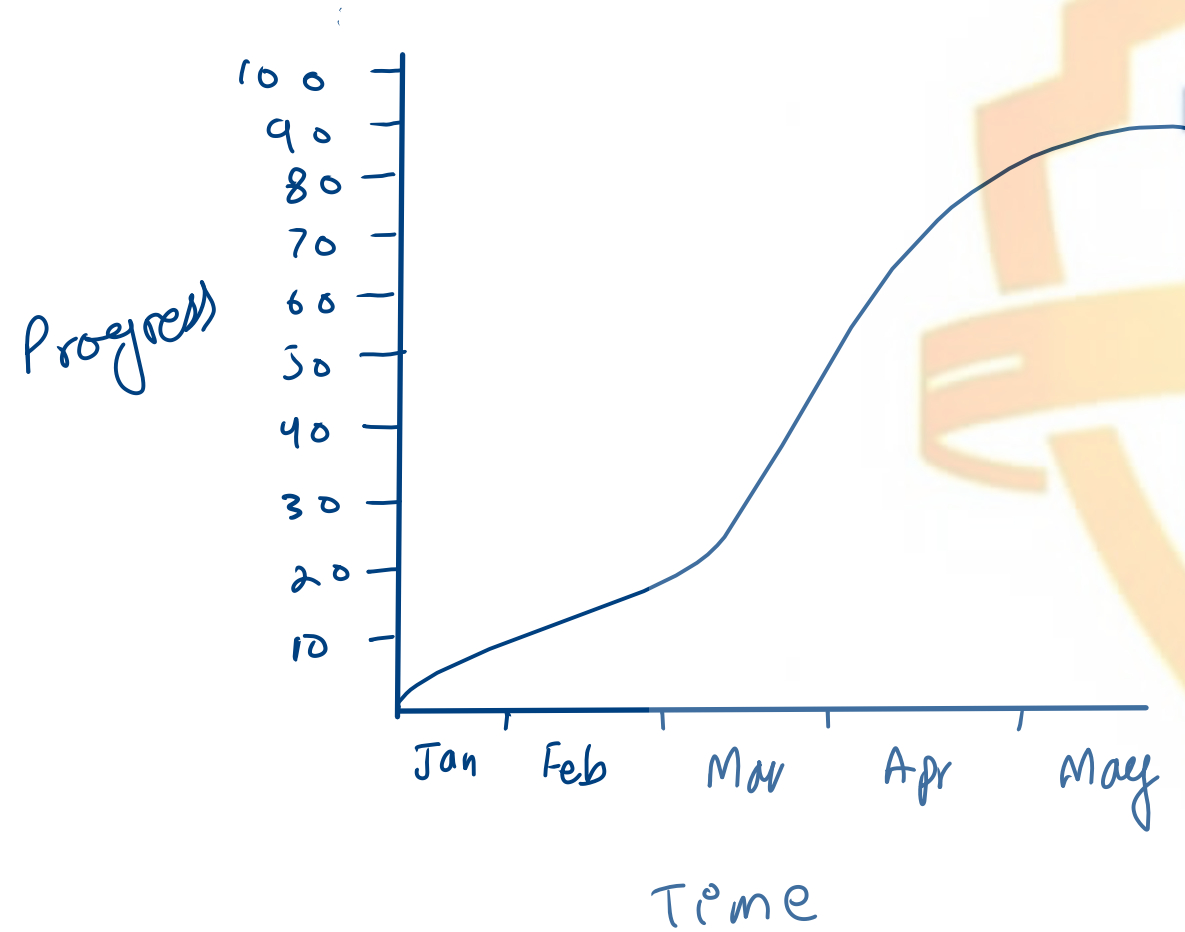
The S-Curve

* An s-curve is a graph that plots resource's consumption over time.

In context of Project Management:

- * An s-curve can track a project's progress by plotting a resource's consumption, such as budget, or hours worked, over time.
- * This can help identify deviation from plan in real time.
- * The s-curve can also be used to help allocate resources, set task order, and create a project schedule.
- * It helps to identify trends and make data driven decisions to ensure that project stays on track.

* The reason it is called S-curve is because the shape of the graph typically forms a loose shallow "S".



The S-curve

The graph forms shape "S", because usually in the beginning the progress is slow. As more progress is made, the growth accelerates rapidly, creating that upward shape that forms the middle part of "S". This point of maximum growth is called point of inflection. After point of inflection, the growth begins to plateau, forming upper part of the curve known as upper asymptote. The upper asymptote is "Mature" phase of project, Because project is finished or winding up.

Common uses of s-curve

- Project Planning or scheduling
An s-curve helps project managers visualize project timeline, anticipate key phase, and manage planned progress effectively.
- Budget Management
The s-curve shows how project costs are expected to accumulate over project's lifecycle. Allowing project manager to plan finances accurately.
- Performance Tracking.
By comparing actual progress against the projected s-curve, managers can see whether tasks are completed on schedule, and adjust resources and timelines if needed to stay on track.

- Risk Management

Early detection of potential delays or budget overruns allow project managers to mitigate risks, before they escalate.

- Stakeholder Communication

An S-curve helps ensure transparent communication with stakeholders. it simplifies complex project data into visual representation, meaning that all parties involved are well informed about project's status, expected time line etc.